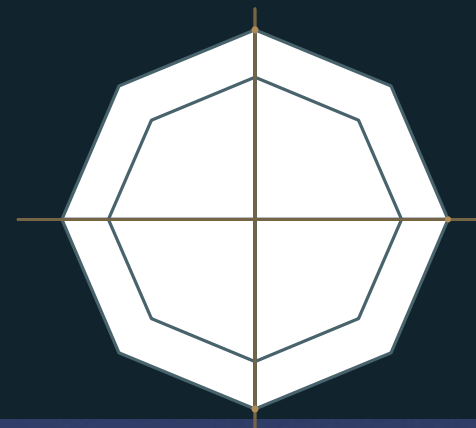

CASE 04 / ARCHITECTURAL DOSSIER

LOUVRE ABU DHABI

JEAN NOUVEL / 2017



RAIN OF LIGHT

**BENEATH A POROUS DOME,
DAYLIGHT BECOMES A
CULTURAL MEDIUM.**

The roof does not simply shelter the museum;
it filters the sky into a moving field of light.

01 PERFORATED CANOPY

Four steel layers break the roof into apertures.

02 FILTERED DAYLIGHT

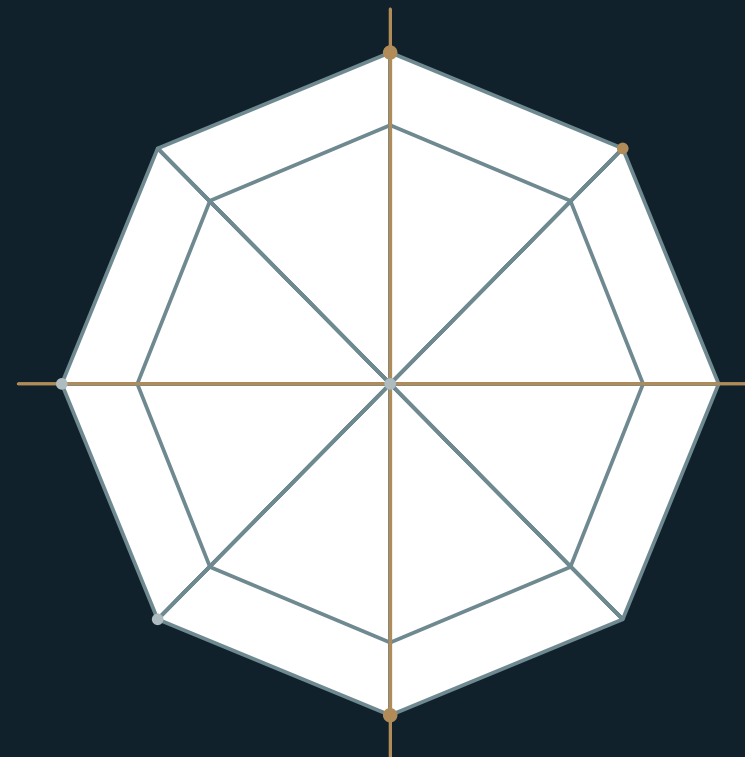
Sunlight becomes a moving field across the floor.



THE DOME AS INSTRUMENT

FOUR OUTER LAYERS OF STAINLESS STEEL
MEET FOUR INNER LAYERS OF ALUMINIUM.

The geometry filters daylight, shades the plaza,
and turns the roof into a climate device.



LAYERED GEOMETRY / POROSITY AS PERFORMANCE

7,850

STARS IN THE PATTERN

repeated apertures

8

OVERLAPPING LAYERS

steel + aluminium

180 M

DOME DIAMETER

museum-city scale

A MUSEUM-CITY / IN THE SEA

SAADIYAT ISLAND · ABU DHABI



55

BUILDINGS

23

GALLERIES

The dome does not sit on the city;
it gathers a city beneath it.



WATER AS PUBLIC ROOM

Paths cross the water beneath the dome,
turning the museum into a walkable urban room.

The visitor does not move around a single object.
The visitor moves through a sequence of thresholds.

01

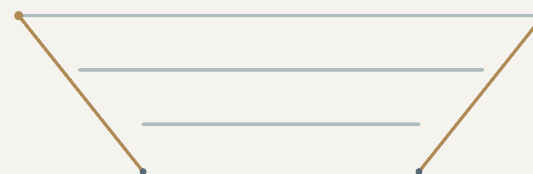
ARRIVAL

land → water → threshold

02

PAUSE

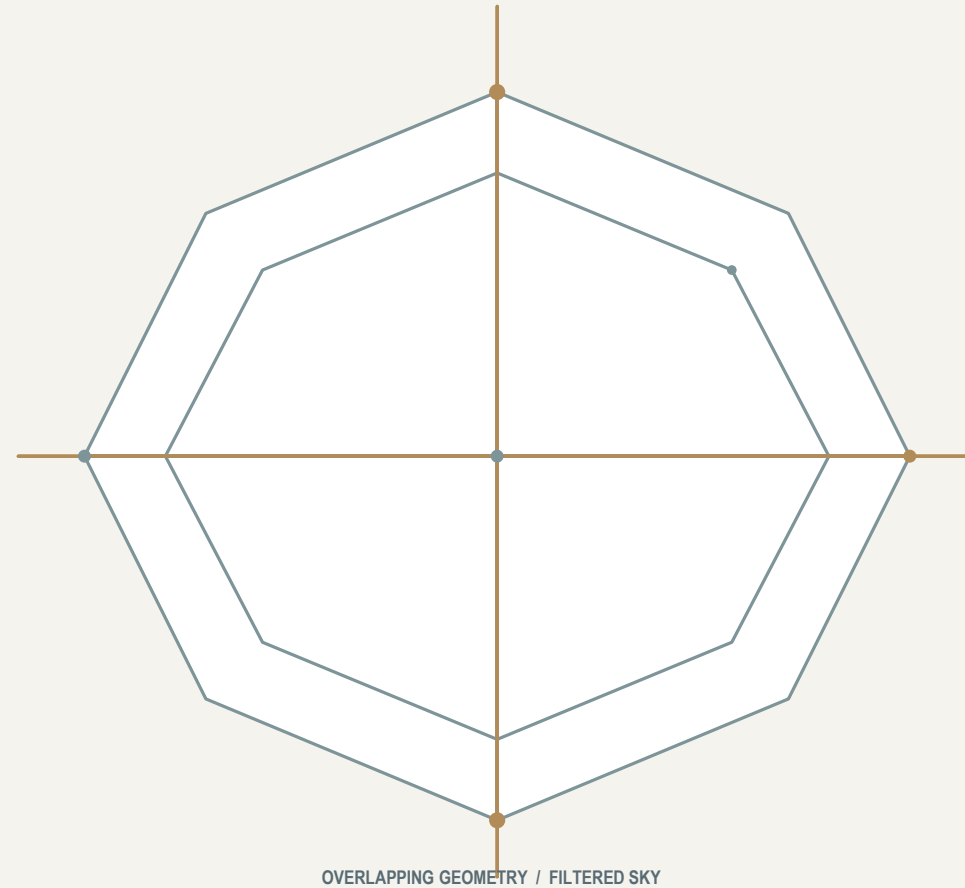
shade → water → room



SHADE BECOMES INFRASTRUCTURE

The canopy filters daylight, reduces heat, and protects the public realm below.

Natural cooling is not an add-on.
It is the spatial idea of the project.



01 SHADE
block direct solar load

02 FILTER
break light into layers

03 SOFTEN
make the plaza inhabitable

36 M

ABOVE GROUND

WALK / PAUSE / RETURN

A MUSEUM DESIGNED AS A JOURNEY



01 / FILTERED DAYLIGHT

ARRIVE THROUGH SHADE



02 / CITY + SEA

ORIENT FROM ABOVE



03 / CIVIC WATER ROOM

RETURN TO WATER



MATERIAL IS A FILTER

Steel, aluminium and patterned voids work as a single optical instrument between sky and ground.

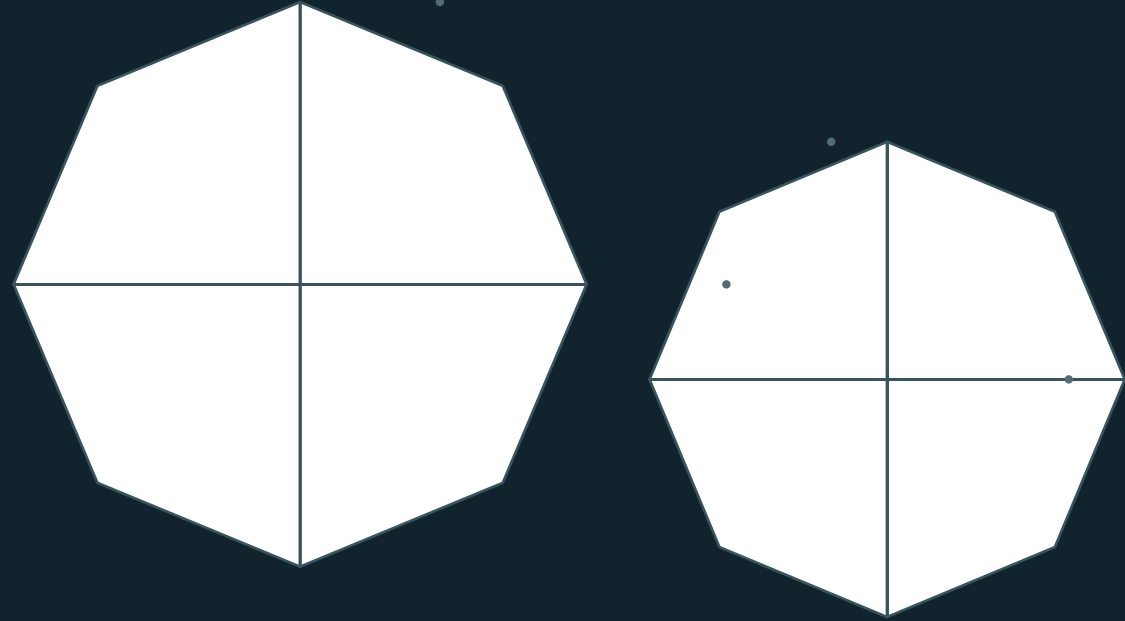
8 LAYERS

4 STAINLESS STEEL / 4 ALUMINIUM

Structure becomes atmosphere:
openings admit light without losing shade.

A WELCOMING WORLD OF LIGHT, SHADOW, REFLECTION AND CALM.

A museum-city that belongs to its geography
without becoming a literal interpretation of it.



-
- | | | |
|----|------------|----------------------|
| 01 | LIGHT | reveals movement |
| 02 | SHADOW | makes room for pause |
| 03 | REFLECTION | joins land and sea |



LOUVRE ABU DHABI / SAADIYAT ISLAND

LIGHT. WATER. CITY.

A common sky turns architecture into a public cultural landscape.

THE CASE CLOSES ON A RELATIONSHIP

A landmark becomes civic when its light, water and paths remain shared.

